

Rayark: Launching better social games faster

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By moving to Google Cloud Platform and using Kubernetes Engine for the backend of its games, Rayark is developing game and offering better experiences to gamers around the world.

ABOUT RAYARK



About Rayark

Rayark is a team of game developers dedicated to creating high-quality gaming experiences and digital content on various platforms, including mobile. Its six major games have been downloaded 60 million times worldwide.

Industries: Gaming

Location: Taiwan

Google
Cloud
Platform
Results

More
60 mi

- Player information downloads more quickly, leading to faster startup
- Accelerates development and Improves game play
- Developers can focus on creating games, not managing infrastructure

down
world

Kubernetes Engine

(<https://cloud.google.com/kubernetes-engine/>)

Cloud Storage (<https://cloud.google.com/storage/>)

API Analytics

(<https://cloud.google.com/api-analytics/>)

BigQuery (<https://cloud.google.com/bigquery/>)

Firebase (<https://firebase.google.com/>)

When Taiwan-based game maker Rayark (<https://www.rayark.com/>)

decided to switch its focus from standalone games to mobile games with social components, it needed infrastructure to support creating network-enabled games

for iOS and
Android. To
deploy software
faster and more
easily while
using fewer
resources,
Rayark chose a
new way to
deploy games—
using
containers.

“We chose containers for the main part of our
technology stack because with it we can build a
continuous integration pipeline and deploy to our
publisher’s platform in China,” says Alvin Chung, CTO
and Co-founder of Rayark. “That makes it much
easier to launch new games, and maintain and
revise existing ones.”

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Google Cloud

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—Alvin Chung, CTO and
Co-founder, Rayark

Initially, Rayark used another cloud provider in concert with container technology, but ran into problems. Rayark found the documentation incomplete and difficult to understand. Deployment sometimes failed. And because of routing issues in Taiwan, Rayark's bandwidth was slow and limited. Rayark chose Google Cloud Platform (<https://cloud.google.com/>) because it scales quickly to meet demand, offers sophisticated analytics tools, and works well with Kubernetes (/kubernetes) open source software for deployment.

“Our previous cloud provider simply wasn't reliable enough for us, so we had to come up with an alternative,” says Alvin. “Google Cloud Platform has accelerated our development process because it's easy to use and has an excellent management console.”

Building better games

Since Rayark was already using Kubernetes container management technology, it immediately knew switching to [Google Kubernetes Engine](https://cloud.google.com/kubernetes-engine/) (<https://cloud.google.com/kubernetes-engine/>) was a smart decision. After all, Google developed Kubernetes, made it open source, and donated it to the [Cloud Native Computing Foundation](https://www.cncf.io/) (<https://www.cncf.io/>). Kubernetes Engine is built on top of Kubernetes, so the two technologies work seamlessly together.

Rayark uses Kubernetes Engine to store and retrieve user-generated data including player scores and all user interactions with its games. The information is used to create user profiles and leaderboards. Data is a key component in the social aspect of Rayark games because it lets users see each other's profiles and add each other as friends. Social gaming engages people more than playing standalone games, and leads to increased time spent playing them. In the future, Rayark will also use Kubernetes Engine to create and host anti-cheating and anti-cracking algorithms.

“Google
Kubernetes
Engine is a key
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our move to
network and
social games.
We believe it will
help set us apart
from ordinary
mobile gaming
because people
are looking for
ways to connect
with one another
when they play.”

*—Alvin Chung, CTO and
Co-founder, Rayark*

Accelerating development, improving game play

Rayark has gained considerable benefits from Google Cloud Platform. When users log in to games, their information downloads quickly from Google Cloud Storage—so they can start playing social games immediately, find friends, and interact. And by freeing engineers from managing infrastructure, Google Cloud Platform has allowed Rayark to keep its development staff small.

“With Google Cloud Platform, we can focus on development and improving gaming performance,

and not have to worry about managing the platform itself," adds Alvin.